

Tips + Tricks with Beamer for Economists

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Color

I use two to three colors regularly throughout my presentations

- I use the blue color everywhere
- I use red to contrast and emphasize
- I use green as a backup
- I use yellow as a transition color

Make your own color wheel palette! <https://www.sessions.edu/color-calculator/>

Background color: I'm undecided

- Changing the background color makes it easier to read
- Make your figures in R or Stata have the same background color
(Or transparent)
- In auditoriums **large**, go black background with white text

Example for an auditorium – contrast is much higher

Fitting figures doesn't have to be painful

- Simple commands to fit figures:

```
\resizebox{0.7\linewidth}{!}{  
  \includegraphics{figure1_effect.pdf}}
```

- The `\linewidth` number is defined within an environment
- Simply center with a `center` environment

Tables

Fitting tables doesn't have to be painful

- Simple commands to fit table and center:

```
\makebox[\linewidth][c]{  
  \begin{tabular}{l cc ddd}  
    results...  
  \end{tabular}
```

- Don't use the `table` environment
- If you don't want to center, use change `[c]` to `[l]`

Highlight cells using tikz (see source code)

	Mean at	Difference-in-Differences Estimates		
	$t = -1$	1 Year	2 Years	3 Years
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Outcome 1	2.58 (2.55)	0.11 (0.04)	0.08 (0.04)	0.12 (0.04)
Outcome 2	60.90 (17.02)	-0.73 (0.10)	-1.13 (0.11)	-1.58 (0.12)
Outcome 3	18.98 (6.74)	0.77 (0.13)	1.28 (0.13)	1.62 (0.12)

Highlight cells using tikz (see source code)

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Dummy Frames

Two Column Frame



Column 1



Column 2

Consider making your math prettier

- Don't overdo it when putting up equations (either regressions or theorems)
- Try adding color and text to highlight the relevant formula
- Consider (Imbens and Angrist 1994):

$$\alpha_g^{IV} = \underbrace{\text{Cov}(Y, g(\textcolor{blue}{Z}))}_{\text{Reduced Form}} / \underbrace{\text{Cov}(D, g(\textcolor{blue}{Z}))}_{\text{First Stage}}$$

Almost done!

- Use the `\appendix` command to restart the numbering
- The frame counter says this is the last slide, but it's not
- (Test it, see you on next page)

Almost done!

- See, now we're in backup slide land
- This is made useful by having links throughout the talk
- Here's a button, which is how I make links [▶ Next slide](#)

Use it to intimidate audiences!

Now you can make it clear you've done a shitload of work
without having to show everything! [▶ Back](#)

You label a frame with the `[label=name]` option, and then point a link to it

You can make an object a link using the `\hyperlink{label}{object}` command